

offers, there's always something new you can learn to improve your skills. Once you get familiar with it, there's no way you'll be looking at any other imaging software again.

In this section we talk about some of the basic things you need to know

about Photoshop that will help you fix just about any kind of minor issues or glitches in your snapshots.

Before we begin, let's familiarise you with some Photoshop basics. First we'll take a look at the Photoshop interface.

There are a few aspects of Photoshop that you should familiarise yourself with right at the beginning so the steps ahead can be much easier.

Layers: In Photoshop, you can modify an image in layers. For instance, if you want to put



The drop-down menus in Photoshop



The 'Layers' palette in Photoshop



TIMESAVER TIP

Here's how to figure out what resolution to scan at: dpi (dots per inch) to set for scanning equals final image width divided by the original image width x the final ppi (points per inch) desired. So if you want to print an 8 x 10 inch enlargement from a 4 x 5 inch photo, divide 10 by 5 which gives you 2. Then multiply that by, say, 200. The result, 400, is the scanner dpi setting to use. To end up with 300 ppi you'd have to scan at 600 dpi.